

Charter

The Institutional Governance Standard for Digital Assets

Timothy Banks | March 2026

Blockchains standardized execution.

Charter standardizes institutional control.

The Systemic Risk Nobody Solved

Digital assets are institutionally held.

Governance remains private, fragmented, and opaque.

Execution is on-chain.

Control is reconstructed after the fact.

As institutional capital scales, governance opacity becomes systemic risk.

The Missing Layer

Blockchains standardized consensus, execution, and settlement.

They did NOT standardize institutional governance.

Custody policy enforcement, approval semantics, and compliance evidence remain proprietary middleware.

Charter defines this missing coordination layer.

What Charter Does

Charter encodes custody governance as deterministic state transitions.

- Threshold approvals
- Timelocks and limits
- Jurisdiction-aware policy enforcement
- Replayable audit evidence

Governance becomes consensus-visible.

Why This Must Be a Protocol

If governance is owned by a single custodian, it cannot become an industry standard.

Standards require neutrality.

Charter is operated by licensed validators across jurisdictions, forming a neutral institutional control network.

Beachhead → Standard

Phase 1: Institutional treasury transfer governance.

High compliance sensitivity.

Clear policy boundaries.

Immediate audit value.

Win one workflow. Expand across the institutional custody surface.

Economics Built for Institutions

No annual license fees.

Institutions pay per governance action.

The token coordinates:

- Validator incentives
- Protocol-native fee distribution
- Governance neutrality

Infrastructure plumbing. Not speculation.

Vision & Raise

Charter becomes the jurisdiction-aware governance substrate for institutional digital asset custody worldwide.

Raise: \$1M pre-seed

Runway: 18–24 months

Milestone: First institutional pilot under production conditions.